BIOGEOCHEMICAL CYCLES AND ECOLOGICAL PYRAMIDS

CYCLE ACCOUNTING FRAME → RESERVOIR CLASSIFICATION → CARBON MOVEMENT → NITROGEN TRANSFORMATION RAIL → NITROGEN ORGANISM MAP → PHOSPHORUS PATH

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◈ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 CYCLE ACCOUNTING FRAME

CYCLE ACCOUNTING FRAME · SYSTEM BOUNDARY · ATMOSPHERE, WATER, SOIL, SEDIMENT AND LIVING BIOMASS INCLUDED · AMOUNT HELD IN ONE RESERVOIR AT A STATED TIME · TRANSFER BETWEEN RESERVOIRS PER STATED TIME · BIOLOGICAL, CHEMICAL OR GEOLOGICAL TRANSFORMATION · INPUTS MINUS OUTPUTS; NEVER ASSUMED FROM ONE ISOLATED STOCK · MUST REMEMBER

SYSTEM BOUNDARY → atmosphere, water, soil, sediment and living biomass included → POOL → amount held in one reservoir at a stated time → FLUX → transfer between reservoirs per stated time → PROCESS → biological, chemical or geological transformation → BALANCE → inputs minus outputs; never assumed from one isolated stock

CORE CLAIM
- SYSTEM BOUNDARY → atmosphere, water, soil, sediment and living biomass included
- POOL → amount held in one reservoir at a stated time

MECHANISM
- FLUX → transfer between reservoirs per stated time
- PROCESS → biological, chemical or geological transformation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BALANCE → inputs minus outputs; never assumed from one isolated stock
- MUST REMEMBER: Biogeochemical cycles move elements among reservoirs through biological,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Biogeochemical cycles move elements among reservoirs through biological,.

01

STAGE 01 RESERVOIR CLASSIFICATION

RESERVOIR CLASSIFICATION · MAJOR ATMOSPHERE OR OCEAN RESERVOIR · MAJOR CRUST, SOIL OR SEDIMENT RESERVOIR · CARBON AND NITROGEN · PROMINENT ATMOSPHERIC EXCHANGE · ROCK-WEATHERING AND SEDIMENT PATHWAY · CLASS DOES NOT SET ONE UNIVERSAL CYCLING SPEED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GASEOUS → major atmosphere or ocean reservoir	CARBON AND NITROGEN → prominent atmospheric exchange	CAUTION → class does not set one universal cycling speed
SEDIMENTARY → major crust, soil or sediment reservoir	PHOSPHORUS → rock-weathering and sediment pathway	GASEOUS → major atmosphere or ocean reservoir

CORE CLAIM
- GASEOUS → major atmosphere or ocean reservoir
- SEDIMENTARY → major crust, soil or sediment reservoir

MECHANISM
- CARBON AND NITROGEN → prominent atmospheric exchange
- PHOSPHORUS → rock-weathering and sediment pathway

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAUTION → class does not set one universal cycling speed
- GASEOUS → major atmosphere or ocean reservoir

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → class does not set one universal cycling speed.

02

STAGE 02 CARBON MOVEMENT

CARBON MOVEMENT · ATMOSPHERIC OR DISSOLVED CARBON · PHOTOSYNTHETIC FIXATION · PRODUCER BIOMASS · CONSUMERS AND DETRITAL PATHWAYS · CARBON RETURNED DURING METABOLISM · DECOMPOSITION AND COMBUSTION · ADDITIONAL RETURN PATHWAYS

ATMOSPHERIC OR DISSOLVED CARBON → photosynthetic fixation → PRODUCER BIOMASS → consumers and detrital pathways → RESPIRATION → carbon returned during metabolism → DECOMPOSITION AND COMBUSTION → additional return pathways → RULE → stored carbon and annual transfer are different measures

CORE CLAIM
- ATMOSPHERIC OR DISSOLVED CARBON → photosynthetic fixation
- PRODUCER BIOMASS → consumers and detrital pathways

MECHANISM
- RESPIRATION → carbon returned during metabolism
- DECOMPOSITION AND COMBUSTION → additional return pathways

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → stored carbon and annual transfer are different measures
- ATMOSPHERIC OR DISSOLVED CARBON → photosynthetic fixation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → stored carbon and annual transfer are different measures.

03

STAGE 03 NITROGEN TRANSFORMATION RAIL

NITROGEN TRANSFORMATION RAIL · ATMOSPHERIC NITROGEN · AMMONIA OR USABLE NITROGEN FORMS · ORGANIC NITROGEN · PLANT UPTAKE OR DENITRIFICATION · RETURN TOWARD ATMOSPHERIC NITROGEN

ATMOSPHERIC NITROGEN → fixation → ammonia or usable nitrogen forms → ORGANIC NITROGEN → ammonification → ammonia → AMMONIA → nitrification → nitrite → nitrate → NITRATE → plant uptake or denitrification → DENITRIFICATION → return toward atmospheric nitrogen

CORE CLAIM
- ATMOSPHERIC NITROGEN → fixation → ammonia or usable nitrogen forms
- ORGANIC NITROGEN → ammonification → ammonia

MECHANISM
- AMMONIA → nitrification → nitrite → nitrate
- NITRATE → plant uptake or denitrification

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DENITRIFICATION → return toward atmospheric nitrogen
- ATMOSPHERIC NITROGEN → fixation → ammonia or usable nitrogen forms

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ATMOSPHERIC NITROGEN → fixation → ammonia or usable nitrogen forms.

04

STAGE 04 NITROGEN ORGANISM MAP

NITROGEN ORGANISM MAP · SYMBIOTIC FIXATION ASSOCIATED WITH LEGUME ROOTS · FREE-LIVING FIXATION EXAMPLE IN THE OWNER · AMMONIA TO NITRITE STEP · NITRITE TO NITRATE STEP · DENITRIFICATION ROUTE

RHIZOBIUM → symbiotic fixation associated with legume roots

AZOTOBACTER → free-living fixation example in the owner → NITROSOMONAS → ammonia to nitrite step → NITROBACTER → nitrite to nitrate step

CORE CLAIM
- RHIZOBIUM → symbiotic fixation associated with legume roots
- AZOTOBACTER → free-living fixation example in the owner

MECHANISM
- NITROSOMONAS → ammonia to nitrite step
- NITROBACTER → nitrite to nitrate step

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PSEUDOMONAS-TYPE → denitrification route
- RHIZOBIUM → symbiotic fixation associated with legume roots

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AZOTOBACTER → free-living fixation example in the owner.

05

STAGE 05 PHOSPHORUS PATH

PHOSPHORUS PATH · PHOSPHATE ROCK · SOIL OR WATER PHOSPHATE · PLANT UPTAKE · CONSUMER TRANSFER · DETRITAL RETURN · AQUATIC LOADING · MINING AND FERTILISER

PHOSPHATE ROCK → weathering → soil or water phosphate → PLANT UPTAKE → consumer transfer → detrital return → RUNOFF → aquatic loading → sedimentation → MINING AND FERTILISER → accelerate extraction and dispersal → BOUNDARY → no significant atmospheric phase in the owner

CORE CLAIM
- PHOSPHATE ROCK → weathering → soil or water phosphate
- PLANT UPTAKE → consumer transfer → detrital return

MECHANISM
- RUNOFF → aquatic loading → sedimentation
- MINING AND FERTILISER → accelerate extraction and dispersal

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BOUNDARY → no significant atmospheric phase in the owner
- PHOSPHATE ROCK → weathering → soil or water phosphate

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → no significant atmospheric phase in the owner.

06

STAGE 06 CYCLE-SPECIFIC HUMAN PRESSURE

CYCLE-SPECIFIC HUMAN PRESSURE · FOSSIL-FUEL COMBUSTION AND LAND-COVER CHANGE · SYNTHETIC FERTILISER AND COMBUSTION-RELATED REACTIVE NITROGEN · MINING, FERTILISER APPLICATION AND RUNOFF · CLIMATE FORCING, NUTRIENT POLLUTION AND RESOURCE LOSS DIFFER · SOURCE CONTROL MUST MATCH THE CYCLE AND RESERVOIR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CARBON → fossil-fuel combustion and land-cover change	PHOSPHORUS → mining, fertiliser application and runoff	POLICY → source control must match the cycle and reservoir
NITROGEN → synthetic fertiliser and combustion-related reactive nitrogen	OUTCOMES → climate forcing, nutrient pollution and resource loss differ	CARBON → fossil-fuel combustion and land-cover change

CORE CLAIM
- CARBON → fossil-fuel combustion and land-cover change
- NITROGEN → synthetic fertiliser and combustion-related reactive nitrogen

MECHANISM
- PHOSPHORUS → mining, fertiliser application and runoff
- OUTCOMES → climate forcing, nutrient pollution and resource loss differ

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- POLICY → source control must match the cycle and reservoir
- CARBON → fossil-fuel combustion and land-cover change

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: POLICY → source control must match the cycle and reservoir.

07

STAGE 07 EUTROPHICATION MECHANISM

EUTROPHICATION MECHANISM · NUTRIENT ENRICHMENT · INCREASED ALGAL OR PLANT PRODUCTION · ORGANIC MATERIAL ACCUMULATES · DECOMPOSER ACTIVITY RISES · OXYGEN DEMAND RISES · DISSOLVED OXYGEN MAY DECLINE · ECOLOGICAL STRESS

NUTRIENT ENRICHMENT → increased algal or plant production → ORGANIC MATERIAL ACCUMULATES → decomposer activity rises → OXYGEN DEMAND RISES → dissolved oxygen may decline → ECOLOGICAL STRESS → composition changes and mortality may occur → CLASSIFY → natural ageing versus human-accelerated cultural eutrophication

CORE CLAIM
- NUTRIENT ENRICHMENT → increased algal or plant production
- ORGANIC MATERIAL ACCUMULATES → decomposer activity rises

MECHANISM
- OXYGEN DEMAND RISES → dissolved oxygen may decline
- ECOLOGICAL STRESS → composition changes and mortality may occur

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLASSIFY → natural ageing versus human-accelerated cultural eutrophication
- NUTRIENT ENRICHMENT → increased algal or plant production

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLASSIFY → natural ageing versus human-accelerated cultural eutrophication.

08

STAGE 08 THREE PYRAMID PARAMETERS

THREE PYRAMID PARAMETERS · COUNT OF ORGANISMS AT EACH TROPHIC LEVEL · STANDING LIVING MATERIAL AT A STATED TIME · TRANSFER THROUGH TROPHIC LEVELS OVER TIME · DEPENDS ON PARAMETER AND ECOSYSTEM · ONLY THE ENERGY PYRAMID IS ALWAYS UPRIGHT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NUMBERS → count of organisms at each trophic level	ENERGY → transfer through trophic levels over time	RULE → only the energy pyramid is always upright
BIOMASS → standing living material at a stated time	SHAPE → depends on parameter and ecosystem	NUMBERS → count of organisms at each trophic level

CORE CLAIM
- NUMBERS → count of organisms at each trophic level
- BIOMASS → standing living material at a stated time

MECHANISM
- ENERGY → transfer through trophic levels over time
- SHAPE → depends on parameter and ecosystem

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → only the energy pyramid is always upright
- NUMBERS → count of organisms at each trophic level

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → only the energy pyramid is always upright.

09

STAGE 09 AQUATIC BIOMASS INVERSION

AQUATIC BIOMASS INVERSION · SMALL PHYTOPLANKTON STANDING CROP · RAPID REPLACEMENT · HIGH TURNOVER · CONTINUED PRODUCTION OVER THE MEASUREMENT PERIOD · CONSUMER STANDING BIOMASS · MAY EXCEED PRODUCER BIOMASS AT ONE INSTANT · ENERGY TRANSFER

SMALL PHYTOPLANKTON STANDING CROP → rapid replacement → HIGH TURNOVER → continued production over the measurement period → CONSUMER STANDING BIOMASS → may exceed producer biomass at one instant → ENERGY TRANSFER → still declines upward → VERDICT → biomass inversion is not energy inversion

CORE CLAIM
- SMALL PHYTOPLANKTON STANDING CROP → rapid replacement
- HIGH TURNOVER → continued production over the measurement period

MECHANISM
- CONSUMER STANDING BIOMASS → may exceed producer biomass at one instant
- ENERGY TRANSFER → still declines upward

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERDICT → biomass inversion is not energy inversion
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Reservoir stock is not flux, residence time is not turnover rate,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → biomass inversion is not energy inversion.

10

STAGE 10 HEURISTIC AND MODEL FIREWALL

HEURISTIC AND MODEL FIREWALL · ENERGY LOSS · QUALITATIVE THERMODYNAMIC DIRECTION IS ROBUST · TEN-PER-CENT RULE · OWNER LABELS IT AN AVERAGE HEURISTIC · WEAKENS A RIGID ONE-LEVEL ASSIGNMENT · CHANGES STANDING STOCKS AND FEEDING RELATIONS · USEFUL SUMMARY, NOT A COMPLETE FOOD WEB

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ENERGY LOSS → qualitative thermodynamic direction is robust	OMNIVORY → weakens a rigid one-level assignment	PYRAMID → useful summary, not a complete food web
TEN-PER-CENT RULE → owner labels it an average heuristic	SEASONALITY → changes standing stocks and feeding relations	EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Name pool, process, direction, limiting...

CORE CLAIM
- ENERGY LOSS → qualitative thermodynamic direction is robust
- TEN-PER-CENT RULE → owner labels it an average heuristic

MECHANISM
- OMNIVORY → weakens a rigid one-level assignment
- SEASONALITY → changes standing stocks and feeding relations

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PYRAMID → useful summary, not a complete food web
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Name pool, process, direction, limiting...

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Name pool, process, direction, limiting...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEN-PER-CENT RULE → owner labels it an average heuristic.

11

STAGE 11 PYQ AND EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

PYQ AND EVIDENCE BOUNDARY · ROUTED CONCEPTS · AGRICULTURAL NITROGEN, ROCK-WEATHERED PHOSPHORUS, FIXATION LINKS · BASIC PRACTICE · RESERVOIR, PROCESS AND ORGANISM DISTINCTIONS · OFFICIAL PAPER · DEMAND WORDING ONLY · NO KEY

ROUTED CONCEPTS → agricultural nitrogen, rock-weathered phosphorus, fixation links → BASIC PRACTICE → reservoir, process and organism distinctions → OFFICIAL PAPER → demand wording only → NO KEY → no option or answer inferred → LIVE CHECK → no rate, pool, efficiency or status imported from a stub

CORE CLAIM
- ROUTED CONCEPTS → agricultural nitrogen, rock-weathered phosphorus, fixation links
- BASIC PRACTICE → reservoir, process and organism distinctions

MECHANISM
- OFFICIAL PAPER → demand wording only
- NO KEY → no option or answer inferred

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LIVE CHECK → no rate, pool, efficiency or status imported from a stub
- ROUTED CONCEPTS → agricultural nitrogen, rock-weathered phosphorus, fixation links

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIVE CHECK → no rate, pool, efficiency or status imported from a stub.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · CPCB MONITORS WATER-QUALITY PARAMETERS (BOD, DISSOLVED OXYGEN, NUTRIENT LOAD) · MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE AND FARMERS WELFARE · DEPARTMENT OF FERTILIZERS · IMPLEMENTATION GAP · FERTILISER SUBSIDY DESIGN IN INDIA HAS HISTORICALLY FAVOURED · CARBON-CYCLE SCIENCE (IPCC AR6, 2023) IS THE SCIENTIFIC SPINE · NATIONAL-SCALE NUTRIENT-CYCLE DISRUPTION (E.G., TOTAL AGRICULTURAL NITROGEN RUNOFF) IS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CPCB monitors water-quality parameters (BOD, dissolved oxygen, nutrient load) that
- Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare / Department of Fertilizers: regulate
- CAUTION: Implementation gap: fertiliser subsidy design in India has historically favoured
- CAUTION: Carbon-cycle science (IPCC AR6, 2023) is the scientific spine of the entire UNFCCC/Paris

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: National-scale nutrient-cycle disruption (e.g., total agricultural nitrogen runoff) is
- CAUTION: "Ecological efficiency of 10%" is an average heuristic; actual transfer efficiency
- Gaseous cycles (carbon, nitrogen, oxygen, water) self-regulate faster than sedimentary
- Biological nitrogen fixation converts atmospheric N_2 to ammonia; industrial fixation via

LEGACY / NUANCE
- The pyramid of energy is always upright due to progressive energy loss at each trophic
- Eutrophication depletes dissolved oxygen as decomposer microbial activity spikes to
- NOT: Nutrient pollution and carbon emissions are governed by the same policy lever. - They
- NOT: An inverted biomass pyramid means an unhealthy ecosystem. - It reflects fast nutrient

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels